recent years that we have managed to break out, first of the post-Partition hyphenation and then from the Indian Ocean box. The reaction to an Indo-Pacific presence is, therefore, only to be expected. One facet of a transformational decade has been to overcome this natural inclination to be a prisoner of our own history.

The difficulties of the past need not always be an encumbrance. The creativity of political leaderships is sometimes demonstrated by an ability to make it an asset in a changed context. In recent years, our nation has seen a renewed interest in Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose and the Indian National Army, as well as in those who resisted British colonialism in an earlier era. The great tribal leader Birsa Munda and the revolutionary Alluri Sitarama Raju are two such cases. While such figures may not have been entirely successful in achieving their immediate objectives, their longer-term impact as inspirational icons is very apparent today. Imageries from history are, in fact, extremely powerful in articulating aspirations for the future.

Indeed, when we look back at our own record over the last seven decades, it is still specific events like the conflicts of 1962, 1965, 1971 and 1999 that stand out as milestones. As India goes about its endeavour to ascend the international hierarchy, it must play well this game of using narratives and experiences to establish practices and habits as well.

The messaging out of New Delhi has also been far more energetic on key issues. *Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam* (the world is one family) conveys a commitment to international cooperation; ‘Reformed Multilateralism’ underlines the urgency of addressing the effectiveness of the UN; ‘A World Free of Terror’ underlines a determination to combat this long-standing threat; ‘Digital for Development’ speaks of how effective it has been as a governance tool; ‘Mother of Democracy’ is a reminder that our pluralistic and consultative traditions go back deep in history; and ‘One World One Health’ is an assertion of the need for timely, effective and non-discriminatory responses to global health challenges.

Developing our own lexicon, concepts, mechanisms and ideas and socializing them in world politics is also a testimony to India’s continued rise. Their unfolding underlines the reality of India’s vigorous participation in global platforms.

Within India, there will always be lively arguments about the balance between continuity and change in our foreign policy. That is only to be expected and, perhaps, in some ways, is even contributory to the emergence